



HEMANT CHAWLA

SLEEP tight

Insufficient sleep is the new obesity villain for over 30 per cent of urban Indians, claimed medics at the conference of Association of Physicians of India in Delhi this month. Loss of sleep alters metabolic pathways that control appetite and energy expenditure. The up-shot? Fat body and tired mind. "We see a sharp rise in the number of young patients," says Dr Manvir Bhatia, head of sleep medicine at Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, Delhi.

Trans Fat Tale



FRIED FOOD

Studies in the journal, *Nutrition*, show that 5.3 per cent of Indian youth gorge on samosas and pakoras at least six times a week, gaining about 215 gm of trans fat a week.

FAST FOOD

About 4.25 per cent of young Indians in the metros dig into pizzas and burgers daily and end up consuming 80 gm of trans fat a week.



33% of India's youth take calorie-dense food three times a week



FIZZY DRINKS

4.8 per cent guzzle aerated drinks (colas) at least four times a week. This pushes up the calorie count in their daily diet by about 280.

SWEET TOOTH

6.3 per cent tuck into burfi, gulab jamun and rasgulla five times a week, without realising that they are collecting 75 gm of trans fat a week.



CUTTING edge

- ✓ It's not just safe, but recommended, to sip water between sets of a long workout.
- ✗ Crunches increase abdominal strength but do not really help increase definition. For that, overall weight loss remains the key.
- ✓ Dense and constantly used muscles like those in your forearms and calves can be safely exercised daily without rest days.

7 CRORE

INDIANS SUFFER FROM MENTAL DISORDERS BUT MORE THAN HALF DON'T SEEK HELP

CRY for health

Even if you can't cry out of sadness or joy, make yourself weep for good health, says a new study from the University of Minnesota, US. It relieves stress and is a protective factor against cardiac and brain damage. The human ability to cry has survival value.



BANDEEP SINGH

Talk About Pleasure

Men think sex while women think food—or so went a 1960s song. But in the new millennium, despite the so-called openness, things haven't really changed. The Asia Pacific Sexual Health and Overall Wellbeing study notes that Indian couples are still not comfortable discussing sex. And sexual satisfaction has a lot to do with love and romance than purely physical gratification. Not surprisingly, sex features seventh on the list of top 17 life priorities for men, while for women it ranks near the bottom 14. Family life is clearly the most important aspect of life for both men and women.